

Cover Letter – Principal Engineer, Contractors Team at Gusto

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Date: [Current Date]

Gusto

[Company Address]

[City, State ZIP]

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Principal Engineer position on the Contractors team at Gusto. Your mission to empower small businesses and create a world where work enables a better life resonates deeply with me. I am inspired by the opportunity to help shape the future of Gusto's flagship Payroll product and to build technology that has a meaningful impact on millions of businesses and their teams.

Why I'm Excited About Gusto

Gusto's commitment to building collaborative, inclusive, and innovative solutions for small businesses aligns perfectly with my own values and experience. I am passionate about architecting and scaling resilient backend systems that simplify complex processes and deliver delightful user experiences. The chance to work on a product that is both mission-critical and deeply impactful is especially motivating.

Relevant Experience & Impact

Backend Architecture & Scalability - Over 20 years of experience designing, building, and maintaining scalable, secure, and resilient backend systems for enterprise and SMB clients (Barclays, McKinsey, Biophy, Yotascale, Boomi, etc.) - Led the architecture and delivery of payroll, financial, and HR systems, with a focus on reliability, compliance, and seamless integration with frontend and third-party services - Deep hands-on experience with cloud-native infrastructure (AWS, Kubernetes, Docker), microservices, and event-driven architectures

Technical Leadership & Cross-Functional Collaboration - Functioned as a technical lead across multiple teams, driving architectural decisions, unblocking engineers, and ensuring high-quality delivery - Mentored and grew engineering teams, established technical standards, and led architecture review boards -

Collaborated closely with Product, Design, Data Science, Compliance, and Operations to deliver holistic and scalable solutions

Product Development & Customer Focus - Drove the product development process from concept to launch, delivering features that simplify payroll, taxes, and compliance for users - Built and optimized RESTful APIs, GraphQL endpoints, and backend services to support customer-facing products at scale - Embraced a collaborative, test-driven environment and continuously stayed up-to-date with backend technologies and methodologies

Why I'm a Strong Fit for Gusto

My experience leading the design and delivery of resilient backend systems, combined with my technical depth and passion for empowering small businesses, positions me to make a significant impact on Gusto's Contractors team. I thrive in highly cross-functional environments and am eager to help scale Gusto's Payroll product to serve even more businesses and contractors worldwide.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and vision align with Gusto's mission and how I can contribute to your continued success.

Sincerely,

Yongjun Rong